

Maria Silva

38, Marlborough Road, Maidenhead, Berkshire · +447935308070 · mariafgsilva10@gmail.com ·
linkedin.com/in/mariafgsilva10

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Dear Hiring Manager,

The litigation paralegal role at Ryder Reid Legal appeals to me because it maps closely onto the work I have been doing in disputes for the past two years, and a boutique firm focused entirely on litigation is where I want to develop further.

My year at BCLP gave me the most direct preparation for this role. In the International Arbitration team I supported a complex investment arbitration from evidence review through to submission of the Claimant's memorial. When I became the only junior supporting the team shortly before a significant deadline, I coordinated documents, tracked outstanding actions across the matter and helped ensure on-time filing. That experience required exactly the kind of deadline management and procedural reliability that trial preparation depends on. In the Real Estate Disputes team I moved into court-facing work: I reviewed documents for hearings, prepared electronic bundles, assisted with skeleton arguments and helped with court filings and hearing arrangements. Both rotations gave me practical exposure to how litigation actually moves from instruction to hearing, and I am comfortable with the administrative and substantive demands that come with it.

Since leaving BCLP I have continued building case management experience at Citizens Advice East Berkshire, where I manage matters end to end. I take detailed client statements, identify evidential gaps, draft correspondence and submissions, and maintain organised case records across welfare, housing, employment and debt matters. Advising vulnerable clients on complex procedural requirements has sharpened how I communicate under pressure, which is a skill just as important in client-facing litigation as the legal research itself.

A boutique firm suits me at this stage. I would rather contribute meaningfully to a smaller team working on serious litigation than take a peripheral role somewhere larger. The fixed-term structure makes sense too: it gives both sides a genuine basis for deciding whether the arrangement works before committing further. I am available immediately and based in London.

Yours sincerely,
Maria Silva